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Original Page: 7**Culture (OWC):** [Luguru \(FN32\)](#)**Region:** Africa**Sub Region:** Eastern Africa**Field Date:** Not Applicable**Coverage Date:** 1800-2009**Place Coverage**

Uluguru Mountains, Morogoro Region, Tanzania

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MEDICINE

Traditional Luguru medicine includes amulets obtained from diviners for protection against witchcraft and misfortune. Some Luguru also place medicine-bundles in their fields to prevent outsiders from stealing crops. Trespassers are believed to become ill from these bundles.

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DEATH AND AFTERLIFE

In the pre-contact period most deaths and many illnesses were attributed to witchcraft. Suspected witches were detected through divination and were subjected to various ordeals. Each clan had a joking partner from another clan who would be called to conduct certain mortuary rites, usually involving sweeping the floor of the deceased's hut, washing the corpse and wrapping it in a burial shroud (sanda), and proclaiming the circumstances of death; additional tasks could include shaving mourners, performing sacrifices at the graveside, and rekindling household fires at the end of mourning. Each lineage owned a designated burial site marked by a sacred grove of trees. Corpses of men were laid on their right sides, those of women on their left sides. Each grave was marked with stones. The deceased's kin mourned for a week, during which they observed a number of restrictions, such as work and cooking, ending with feasts and rites held at the grave.

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CREDITS

The culture summary was written by Teferi Abate Adem in June, 2020.

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